

Health & Wellness

News Digest — Q1 2026

A curated collection of the latest research and insights across nutrition, pharmacology, mental health, and preventive medicine. Sources include NPR, WebMD, Healthline, Mayo Clinic, and BBC Health.

FEATURED ARTICLE

GLP-1 & Addiction

NPR

Health & Wellness Digest 2026

Image: GLP-1s have transformed weight loss and diabetes. Is addiction next? — NPR

GLP-1s have transformed weight loss and diabetes. Is addiction next?

Source: NPR | **Author:** Jon Hamilton | **Published:** 2026-03-10

A large study found that people taking GLP-1 drugs like Ozempic for diabetes were less likely to be diagnosed with substance use disorder.

A large-scale study involving over 600,000 veterans demonstrated that individuals prescribed GLP-1 receptor agonists for diabetes management showed approximately 15% lower rates of substance use disorder diagnoses. Researchers believe the drugs may modulate reward pathways in the brain,

reducing compulsive behaviours associated with addiction. This finding opens a new frontier for GLP-1 treatments beyond their established roles in weight management and glycaemic control.

ARTICLE SUMMARY TABLE — WITH BORDERS

The table below summarises all five articles in this digest, including source, author, and publication date. Bordered tables are ideal for structured data comparison.

#	Title	Source	Author	Date
1	GLP-1s have transformed weight loss and diabetes. Is ad...	NPR	Jon Hamilton	2026-03-10
2	Mediterranean Diet Linked to Lower Risk of Heart Diseases...	WebMD	Sarah Klein	2026-03-08
3	7 Science-Backed Benefits of Intermittent Fasting	Healthline	Rachael Ajmera	2026-03-05
4	Mental Health and Exercise: What's the Connection?	Mayo Clinic Staff	Mayo Clinic	2026-03-01
5	Ultra-processed foods linked to early death, major stud...	BBC Health	James Gallagher	2026-02-25

VISUAL HIGHLIGHTS



Image: Mediterranean Diet Linked to Lower Risk of Heart Disease — WebMD



Image: 7 Science-Backed Benefits of Intermittent Fasting — Healthline

KEY STATISTICS — NO BORDERS

Borderless tables convey information with a cleaner, more editorial look. Subtle row shading maintains readability without visible grid lines.

Statistic	Value	Context
GLP-1 addiction risk reduction	~15%	Study of 600,000+ veterans
Heart disease risk reduction (Mediterranean diet)	28%	25,000 participants over 10 years
Antidepressant equivalence (exercise)	Comparable	49 clinical trial review
Ultra-processed food mortality risk increase	~19%	20-country Lancet study
Average weight loss — orforglipron trial	~20 lbs	Eli Lilly clinical trial, 2026

MORE ARTICLES

Mediterranean Diet Linked to Lower Risk of Heart Disease

WebMD · Sarah Klein · 2026-03-08

New research confirms that adherence to the Mediterranean diet significantly reduces the risk of cardiovascular events in adults over 50.

7 Science-Backed Benefits of Intermittent Fasting

Healthline · Rachael Ajmera · 2026-03-05

From weight loss to improved brain function, intermittent fasting has a growing body of evidence supporting its health benefits.

Mental Health and Exercise: What's the Connection?

Mayo Clinic Staff · Mayo Clinic · 2026-03-01

Regular physical activity can ease symptoms of depression and anxiety, and experts now say it should be a standard part of mental health treatment.

Ultra-processed foods linked to early death, major study finds

BBC Health · James Gallagher · 2026-02-25

People who eat large amounts of ultra-processed foods face a significantly higher risk of premature death, according to research spanning 20 countries.

ADDITIONAL VISUALS

Exercise & Mental Health

Mayo Clinic

Health & Wellness Digest 2026

Image: Mental Health and Exercise: What's the Connection? — Mayo Clinic Staff

Ultra-Processed Foods

BBC Health

Health & Wellness Digest 2026

Image: Ultra-processed foods linked to early death, major study finds — BBC Health